articulated the need for the head of the central bank to be open to suggestions and provide answers to questions raised.

Commenting on this paper, Praveen Chakravarty, a Senior Fellow at IDFC Institute, opined, 'Urjit Patel, the meticulous researcher of 2012, would have concluded that there was no substance in the government's theory of an inordinate rise in currency in circulation or high-denomination notes in the last five years. Urjit Patel, of the 2012 vintage, would not have waited to release detailed numbers of currency deposits in banks, he would have explained the basis for radical policy decisions such as rationing currency in the nation in the absence of a financial emergency and would have been very transparent about the decision-making process of the RBI, about one of the most significant central bank decisions taken globally in recent history.'[64]

My Perspective

One of the most regrettable consequences of demonetization has been its impact on the reputation of bankers and the loss of respect and credibility that the RBI has had to suffer.

India's central bank has been one of the most highly regarded institutions in the country. Widely respected by their peers globally, successive Governors of the RBI had been credited with taking a firm and autonomous stance on numerous issues, notwithstanding pressure from the MoF and the Central Government.

It is clear from what he has said that Governor Rajan had raised red flags about the note ban and cautioned the government about proceeding without adequate preparation. The logistic challenges and preparations needed for the step were also clearly articulated in the April 2016 SBI Ecowrap report.

Despite these clear warnings, no mitigating actions were taken in the 10-month planning period to avoid inconvenience to people and to prevent grievous damage to the economy. By passively agreeing to a